From Discourse Maps to Discovery Networks

Stanley's perspective suggests a shift: don't just map what researchers know—help them discover what to explore next.

• **Maven** connects conversations through shared interests, with room for unexpected encounters. A discourse map could likewise surface bridges across disciplines—not just familiar results. [1]

• **Picbreeder** lets people branch from others' creations. Research maps could support the same pattern: preserve a starting point, fork an interpretation, pursue a new direction. [2]

• **Novelty search** rewards difference rather than only progress toward a fixed goal. It opens a complementary search mode: "show me something unfamiliar but potentially fruitful." [2]

• **Serendipity** becomes a design goal. Let researchers move between focused retrieval and exploratory discovery; today's detour may become another team's steppingstone. [1, 2]

• **Knowledge frameworks** keep exploration coherent. ISO 25964 and SKOS organize themes; Topic Maps adds context; Web Annotation captures interpretations; PROV tracks origins; RDF/OWL connects and formalizes the pieces. [3–8]

The opportunity: a nanopub-based network that preserves evidence, welcomes competing paths, and makes discovery easier—without confusing an intriguing connection with an established finding.

Design implications above are a synthesis, not claims that Stanley developed these knowledge frameworks or a formal discourse-mapping standard.

References

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